ELVIS ZAK MASEMBE

Front-End Developer

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PROFILE

Front-end developer with a UX/UI design background and an Interactive Media Design diploma from Algonquin College (Dean's Honours List). Builds responsive, accessible interfaces in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, TypeScript and React, from Next.js and Tailwind sites deployed on Vercel to Shopify and WordPress builds. Turns Figma designs into working code and works closely with designers, having designed most of the products he builds. Brings 3+ years of freelance digital work, 15+ multimedia projects delivered, and client work with Nova Studio that won a Participants' Choice Award.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: HTML5 · CSS3 · JavaScript (ES6+) · TypeScript · PHP · MDX

Frameworks & libraries: React · Next.js · React Router · Tailwind CSS · Bootstrap · GSAP

CMS & e-commerce: WordPress · Shopify · Drupal

Tools & workflow: Git, GitHub · Vercel · GitHub Pages · pnpm · Playwright · Responsive, mobile-first & accessible development · Cross-device testing

Design: Figma, Figma Make · Adobe XD · Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator · Wireframing & prototyping · Design systems & component libraries

SELECTED PROJECTS

Kawempe Decorous Nursery & Primary School – School Website (Client Project) *2025*

Web Developer | kawempedecorus.com | elviszak-porfolio.site/projects/kawempe-decorus

- Built a live website from the ground up for a nursery and primary school in Kampala, Uganda, in semantic HTML5, CSS3 and JavaScript
- Developed a 5-page site (Home, About Us, Academics & Admissions, Gallery, Contact Us) with dedicated pages for Nursery through Primary Seven programs, curriculum and admissions
- Wrote custom, mobile-first CSS for layout, spacing and responsive behaviour, since most of the school's visitors browse on phones
- Added JavaScript navigation and UI interactions, a photo gallery of school life, and admissions calls to action across the site
- Kept the structure simple so school staff can maintain the content

Personal Portfolio Website *Jan 2025 – Present*

Web Developer & Designer | elviszak-porfolio.site | github.com/mase0016/elvis-portfolio

- Built and maintain a responsive, mobile-first portfolio in Next.js, React, TypeScript and Tailwind CSS, managed with pnpm and deployed on Vercel
- Structured every case study as an MDX file rendered as a dynamic page, so adding a new project is a single new file
- Built reusable components: filterable project cards, previous/next project navigation, and a contact form that emails submissions directly
- Built a custom PhoneEmbed MDX component that embeds live, fully interactive prototypes inside an iPhone-style frame
- Added GSAP scroll reveals and page transitions, and served images through Next.js image optimization
- Automated high-resolution project screenshots with Playwright, and debugged pnpm workspace and deployment configuration

RentEasy Uganda – Rental Marketplace App *2026*

Solo Designer & Developer | elviszak-porfolio.site/projects/renteasy-uganda

- Built a coded, interactive prototype in React and TypeScript with React Router (via Figma Make): 40+ screens across 3 role-based flows for renters, property owners and housekeepers
- Managed state across screens, including the selected listing, basket contents and live running totals, so every flow works end to end with no dead ends
- Implemented dynamic pricing by house size and cleaning type, quantity steppers, auto-calculated UGX totals, and local formats (+256 phone numbers, real Kampala districts)
- Built on a shared component system (header, role-based bottom navigation, cards, buttons, 5-colour palette) and designed for Android-first use on 3G connections
- Iterated through 3 versions based on usability testing, adding guest browsing and a full housekeeper role
- Weighed 3 product concepts and ran usability tests with renters and property owners before building, synthesizing findings into 3 personas and end-to-end user journeys

Active Life Center – Community Fitness Website *July 2025*

Web Developer & Designer | elviszak-porfolio.site/projects/active-life-center

- Coded a responsive, mobile-first website in HTML, CSS, JavaScript and Bootstrap from original Figma designs, deployed with Git and GitHub Pages
- Built a programs hub with age and skill-level filters, and a step-by-step registration flow with multi-child sign-up in one checkout
- Built for accessibility: sticky navigation, short registration steps, a larger base font and higher-contrast text for older users
- Tested on real devices and iterated on the build from user feedback
- Designed for 3 user groups found through interviews (students, families and seniors), working to a target of a parent finding a suitable program in under a minute
- Built facility pages (pool, ice rink, gym, steam rooms, classes), testimonials, and FAQ and policy sections from a reusable Bootstrap layout

Anime Sticker & Figure Store – Shopify E-commerce Site *2025*

Web Developer & Designer | elviszak-porfolio.site/projects/anime-sticker-miniature-figure-store

- Built and launched a live Shopify storefront using the theme editor: product grid, collection pages filtered by price and availability, blog, contact page, cart and checkout
- Added conversion features: a free-shipping threshold bar, a countdown timer app, sale badges and email signup
- Reduced browsing overload with consistent product cards and filters, and removed shipping-cost uncertainty with a threshold message in the top bar

Tallya – Public Safety Mobile App (Team Project) *Spring 2026*

UX/UI Designer & Documentation Lead, 5-person team | Client: Nova Studio | elviszak-porfolio.site/projects/tallya

- Owned the tablet version of the staff app, designing its screens and components and building its interactive Figma prototype for developer handoff
- Helped build the shared component library and design system used across the patron and staff apps
- Contributed to competitive analysis (bSafe, Noonlight), 3 personas, patron and staff journey maps, and 2 rounds of information architecture
- Led team documentation through 5 client sign-off milestones, and co-built the 24-slide findings presentation and final handoff package
- Won the Participants' Choice Award at Algonquin College's Spring 2026 Technology Project Showcase

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Digital Designer & Front-End Developer *Jan 2023 – Present*

Ottawa, ON

- Built and launched a live, mobile-first website for Kawempe Decorous Nursery & Primary School in Kampala (see Projects)
- Design and build digital assets and web content for schools, startups and local businesses, from brand identities to website layouts
- Advise clients on UI layout and visual hierarchy to improve website navigation and engagement
- Prepare optimized graphics and media for web and social platforms using Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator and Canva
- Manage clients remotely from brief to final files, gathering feedback and iterating to meet tight deadlines

Freelance Photographer & Videographer *Jan 2024 – Present*

Ottawa, ON

- Produce photo and short-form video content for clients' websites and social media campaigns, edited in Lightroom, Premiere Pro, After Effects and Audition
- Work with clients to understand their vision, delivering multimedia packages on tight deadlines and earning repeat business

Hotel Housekeeping (Part-Time) *2023 – 2025*

Fairfield by Marriott | Ottawa, ON

EDUCATION

Interactive Media Design Diploma *Jan 2025 – Aug 2026*

Algonquin College | Ottawa, ON

- Cumulative GPA 3.8/4.0 | Dean’s Honours List
- Relevant coursework: front-end web development, CMS development (WordPress, Shopify, Drupal), UX/UI design

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEER

Class Representative – Interactive Media Design Program *May 2025 – Aug 2026*

Algonquin College | Ottawa, ON

- Represented 60 students in program meetings, bringing student concerns and ideas to coordinators
- Acted as liaison between students and coordinators to resolve academic and scheduling issues
- Organized group study sessions and feedback forums, and promoted student engagement in college events

Student Orientation Volunteer *May 2025 (Orientation Week)*

Algonquin College | Ottawa, ON

- Guided incoming students around campus and answered questions about schedules, resources and procedures, easing their move into college life
- Helped create a positive first impression of Algonquin College through professional and helpful interactions

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- Participants' Choice Award – Algonquin College Spring 2026 Technology Project Showcase (Tallya)
- Dean's Honours List – Algonquin College, Interactive Media Design